



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE

People, Personalities and Dinner Parties

Discussion and Debate - Week 1
LSE Pre-sessional

Session Content

- Brief introduction to the course
- A quick game of “Guess Who?”
- Developing conversations (what makes a good conversation?)
- Planning a dinner party

Discussion and Debate

- The purpose of this course is to help you develop your confidence, speaking skills and social skills.
- A low-pressure course to discuss interesting (and fun?!) topics while developing your language skills.
- The more you participate, the more you benefit!

Guess Who?

- Instructions

1. Complete the profile handout **but don't write your name on it.**
2. Be as honest and specific as possible. The more interesting your answers are, the more enjoyable the activity will be.
3. When everyone has finished, your teacher will collect the sheets, shuffle them, and give each student a different profile.
4. Your task is to walk around the room, asking questions to discover **whose profile you are holding.**
5. Once you think you have found the correct person, ask one final question to confirm before introducing them briefly to the class.

Guess Who? Rules

Rules

- Do **not** show anyone your profile.
- You may only ask **two questions** before moving on to another classmate.
- Try to speak to as many different people as possible.
- Don't simply ask, "*Is this yours?*" Use the information on the sheet to ask natural questions instead.
 - Examples:
 - Do you enjoy travelling?
 - Are you studying International Relations?
 - Do you enjoy cooking?
 - Which historical figure would you invite to dinner?
 - Etc.

A Good Conversation

What makes for a good conversation?

Have a discussion at your table, and see if you can agree on five ideas.

A Good Conversation - Ideas

- asking interesting questions
- listening carefully
- giving examples
- showing curiosity
- including others
- not interrupting (or interrupting politely)
- showing a sense of humour (where and when appropriate!)
- explaining ideas clearly
- Coincidentally, these are also all important in academic/seminar discussions...

Sustaining a Conversation

Conversation 1	Conversation 2
A: Where are you from? B: Japan. A: Cool.	A: Where are you from? B: Japan. A: Great, which part? B: Osaka. A: I've always wanted to visit. What do you like most about living there? B: ...

Sustaining a Conversation

- Here are four important strategies for sustaining a conversation:
 - Ask a follow-up question
 - Ask for an example
 - Show genuine interest
 - Connect to your own experiences

Conversation Club

- You will now have conversations with a partner for 3 minutes, before rotating to a new partner.
- Start with someone you haven't spoken to yet. After 3 minutes, switch to someone else! **Here are some suggested prompts:**
 - Why did you choose your Master's programme?
 - Tell me about a place that is special to you.
 - What is one skill you hope to develop from this course?
 - Tell me about a tradition from your country that visitors often find interesting.
 - What has surprised you most since arriving in the UK?

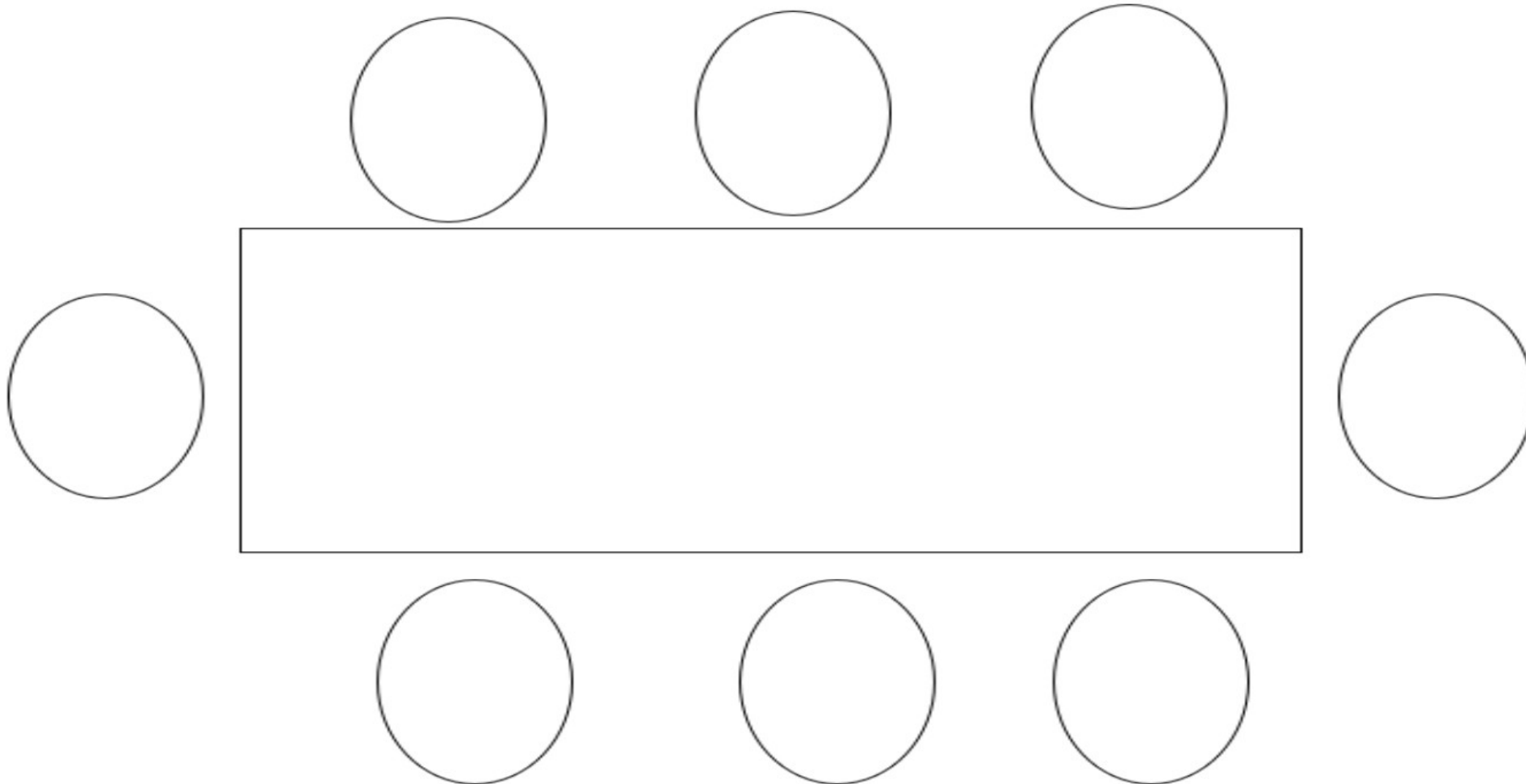
The Dinner Party

- You and your group are hosting a dinner party.
- While you have 12 interesting friends to choose from, unfortunately your dining table only has 7 spare seats (your "group" has 1 seat)
- You and your group need to decide who to invite!
- Download the document **Dinner Party Profiles** from Moodle.

The Dinner Party

- Which seven people would you invite?
- Why would they make interesting dinner guests?
- Which personalities might clash?
- Who would sit next to whom?
- Which conversations are most likely to happen?
- Who might dominate the discussion?
- How would you make sure everyone feels included?

Who should sit where, and why?



The Dinner Party

- Each group should now tell us:
- Who did you invite, and why?
- Were there any difficult decisions you needed to make?
- Are there any particularly interesting conversations that you think will take place?

Reflection

- Spend a few moments reflecting on today's lesson.
- What did you learn about conversations today?
- What can you take from today's lesson and apply immediately to your daily conversations / social interactions?
- Is there a particular discussion/conversation skill you'd like to practice and improve?